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READY WHEN NEEDED

Build Your 90-Day Home Reserve

Use what you already own. Buy what you actually eat. Build gradually.

Start with 3 days. Build toward 90.

3	14	30	90
DAYS	DAYS	DAYS	DAYS
1 · START	2 · PREPARE	3 · BUILD	4 · EXTEND
3 gal water / person	14 gal water / person	30 gal water / person	90 gal water / person

HOW TO USE THIS LIST

Per person items: multiply by the number of people in your home.

Per household items: one set covers the home.

Amounts in the lists are 90-day amounts. For 14 days, buy about 1/6. For 30 days, buy about 1/3.

A dot (•) in the **3-DAY** column marks a Stage 1 essential: get these first. They count toward your 90-day totals. They are not extra.

Mark each line: **Have** · **Need** · **Expires**.

LEAVE NOW AND CALL 911

Gas smell · Downed power lines · Unsafe building

CARBON MONOXIDE KILLS

Never run a generator, grill, camp stove, or heater indoors, in a garage, or near windows.

STAGE 1 · FIRST 3 DAYS · NO COOKING (per person)

Food that needs no heat and no water. These items count toward your 90-day totals. They are not extra.

- ☐ **Water** — 3 gallons
- ☐ **Canned meat or fish (pop-top)** — 3 cans
- ☐ **Peanut butter or other nut butter** — 1 jar
- ☐ **Crackers** — 1 box
- ☐ **Canned fruit or fruit cups** — 3
- ☐ **Granola or protein bars** — 6
- ☐ **Shelf-stable milk or juice boxes** — 3
- ☐ **Trail mix or nuts** — 1 bag
- ☐ **Manual can opener** — 1 per household

WATER

Per person: 1 gallon per day for drinking and basic hygiene. Add more for heat, illness, nursing, cooking, and pets.

3-DAY	ITEM	90-DAY AMOUNT	HAVE	NEED	EXPIRES
●	**Water, per person**	90 gallons (1 gal/day)	☐	☐	

WATER GEAR

Per household

3-DAY	ITEM	90-DAY AMOUNT	HAVE	NEED	EXPIRES
	Food-grade containers: 5–7 gal jugs and/or 55-gal barrels	Enough to hold your total	☐	☐	
	Siphon pump (for barrels)	1	☐	☐	
	Gravity water filter	1	☐	☐	
●	**Water treatment tablets**	2 packs	☐	☐	
	Unscented regular bleach, dated	1–2 bottles	☐	☐	
	Dropper	1	☐	☐	
	Coffee filters or clean cloth (pre-filter cloudy water)	1 pack	☐	☐	

KNOW THE WEIGHT

Water weighs about 8.3 lb per gallon. 90 days for one person is about **750 lb**. Store it on a ground floor or slab, never on a balcony or upper floor.

BACKUP WATER SOURCES

You don't have to store all 90 days, but know your backups:

Safe to drink: water in your water heater tank and pipes, and ice cubes made before the emergency, only if you shut the main water valve before contamination gets in. Turn off the heater power or gas before draining it.

Treat before drinking: rainwater, streams, and lakes. Do not use them if they may contain fuel, chemicals, or floodwater.

Verified public water distribution points: follow local announcements.

Pools and spas: for cleaning and flushing only. Never drink this water.

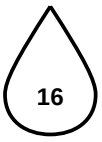
TREATING WATER (CDC)

Boiling is best when you can do it safely outdoors: bring water to a rolling boil for **1 minute** (3 minutes above 6,500 ft). Let it cool.

If you can't boil, use bleach:

1. Use regular, unscented bleach (5–9%). Check the label.
2. If cloudy, let it settle, then filter through a cloth or coffee filter.
3. Add bleach:

Clear water:
8 drops per gallon



Cloudy, colored, or very cold water:
16 drops per gallon

4. Stir and wait **30 minutes**. It should smell slightly of chlorine. If not, repeat the dose and wait 15 more minutes.
5. Replace bleach yearly. It weakens over time.

Boiling and bleach do NOT remove fuel or chemicals. If water may contain them, use stored water only.

FOOD

Per person, 90 days. Target: about 2,000 calories a day for adults, less for young children. Quantities are planning estimates, not a verified 90-day meal plan. Check calories, serving sizes, and dietary needs for your household. Choose foods you already eat. Swap freely within each group.

Protein

Per person

3-DAY	ITEM	90-DAY AMOUNT	HAVE	NEED	EXPIRES
●	**Canned meat or fish (chicken, tuna, salmon, ham)**	45 cans	☐	☐	
	Canned beans or chili	45 cans	☐	☐	
	Dry beans and lentils	10 lb	☐	☐	
●	**Peanut butter or other nut butter**	4 jars	☐	☐	

Staples

Per person

3-DAY	ITEM	90-DAY AMOUNT	HAVE	NEED	EXPIRES
	White rice	20 lb	☐	☐	
	Dry pasta	10 lb	☐	☐	
	Oatmeal	5 lb	☐	☐	
	Instant potatoes	3 packs	☐	☐	
	Ramen or quick noodles	18 packs	☐	☐	
●	**Crackers**	4 boxes	☐	☐	
	Breakfast cereal	4 boxes	☐	☐	

Fruit, vegetables & ready meals

Per person

3-DAY	ITEM	90-DAY AMOUNT	HAVE	NEED	EXPIRES
	Canned vegetables	60 cans	☐	☐	
	Canned tomatoes or sauce	18 cans or jars	☐	☐	
●	**Canned fruit or fruit cups**	36	☐	☐	
	Dried fruit	2 lb	☐	☐	
	Canned soups, stews, and pasta meals	45 cans	☐	☐	

Milk, fats, sugar & extras

Per person

3-DAY	ITEM	90-DAY AMOUNT	HAVE	NEED	EXPIRES
	Powdered milk	4–6 gal yield	☐	☐	
●	**Evaporated or shelf-stable milk**	18 cans or cartons	☐	☐	
	Cooking oil	1 gallon	☐	☐	
	Sugar or honey	5 lb	☐	☐	
●	**Nuts or trail mix**	4 lb	☐	☐	
●	**Granola bars**	4 boxes	☐	☐	
	Coffee, tea, cocoa, drink mix	As your household uses them	☐	☐	
	Electrolyte packets	1 box	☐	☐	
	Comfort foods (candy, cookies, chocolate)	A few bags	☐	☐	

Pantry basics

Per household (flour is per person)

3-DAY	ITEM	90-DAY AMOUNT	HAVE	NEED	EXPIRES
	Flour	10 lb per person	☐	☐	
	Instant yeast, baking powder, baking soda	1 each	☐	☐	
	Salt, seasonings, bouillon	Assorted	☐	☐	

Bread basics: flour + water + salt. Add yeast for risen bread, baking powder for quick bread. Remember: rice, beans, and pasta need clean water and cooking fuel.

COOKING

Per household

3-DAY	ITEM	90-DAY AMOUNT	HAVE	NEED	EXPIRES
	Outdoor camp stove	1	☐	☐	
	20-lb propane tanks with stove adapter hose	See fuel estimate	☐	☐	
	Lighters	2	☐	☐	
	Matches	2 boxes	☐	☐	

ESTIMATE YOUR FUEL

1. Find your stove's fuel use on its label or manual (BTU per hour, per burner).

2. A full 20-lb propane tank holds about 430,000 BTU.

Tank hours	= 430,000 ÷ your burner's BTU per hour
Tanks needed	= hours of cooking per day × 90 ÷ tank hours

Use only a hose and regulator rated for your stove and a 20-lb tank.

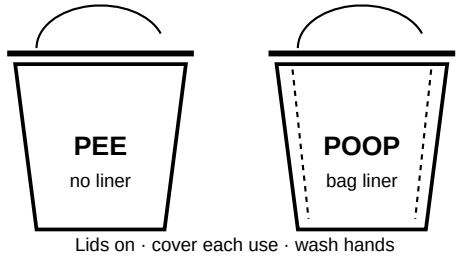
Cook outdoors only. Store tanks outside, upright, and out of direct sun.

TOILET BACKUP

Per household of 2–4; double for more

3-DAY	ITEM	90-DAY AMOUNT	HAVE	NEED	EXPIRES
	5-gallon buckets with lids	2	☐	☐	
	Toilet seat that fits a bucket	1	☐	☐	
	Heavy contractor bags	50 for 2 people, 100 for 4	☐	☐	
	Cat litter, sawdust, or shredded paper	25 lb	☐	☐	
	Handwashing station: water jug with spout, soap, towels	1	☐	☐	

TWO-BUCKET SETUP



Lids on · cover each use · wash hands

1. Label one bucket PEE and one bucket POOP.
2. Line the POOP bucket with a heavy bag.
3. After each use, cover with a scoop of litter or sawdust. Keep lids on.
4. When a bag is 1/3 full, tie it, double-bag it, and store it in a covered bin away from water and living spaces.
5. Wash hands every time.
6. Follow local instructions for disposal.

HYGIENE

Per person

3-DAY	ITEM	90-DAY AMOUNT	HAVE	NEED	EXPIRES
	Toilet paper	36–48 rolls	☐	☐	
	Bar soap	6 bars	☐	☐	
	Shampoo	2 bottles	☐	☐	
	Toothpaste	3 tubes	☐	☐	
	Spare toothbrushes	2	☐	☐	
	Deodorant	2	☐	☐	
	Feminine products	90 days, if needed	☐	☐	
	Baby wipes	4 packs	☐	☐	
	Diapers and formula	90 days, if infants	☐	☐	

CLEANING

Per household

3-DAY	ITEM	90-DAY AMOUNT	HAVE	NEED	EXPIRES
	Hand soap	4 refills	☐	☐	
●	**Hand sanitizer**	2 bottles	☐	☐	
	Dish soap	3 bottles	☐	☐	
	Laundry detergent	90–120 loads	☐	☐	
	Paper towels	12 rolls	☐	☐	
	Disinfecting wipes	4 tubs	☐	☐	
	Trash bags	2 boxes	☐	☐	
	Zip bags	2 boxes	☐	☐	
	Foil and plastic wrap	2 rolls each	☐	☐	
	Rubber gloves	2 pairs	☐	☐	
	Scrub brushes	2	☐	☐	

LIGHT, POWER & COMMS

Per household. Use LED lights, not candles. Candles start fires.

3-DAY	ITEM	90-DAY AMOUNT	HAVE	NEED	EXPIRES
●	**Flashlights**	3	☐	☐	
	LED lanterns	2	☐	☐	
	Headlamp	1 per person	☐	☐	
●	**AA and AAA batteries**	48 each	☐	☐	
	C/D batteries	As needed	☐	☐	
●	**NOAA weather radio (hand-crank or battery)**	1	☐	☐	
●	**USB power banks**	2	☐	☐	
	Spare charging cables	Spares	☐	☐	
	Solar charger	Optional	☐	☐	

MEDICAL & SAFETY · PER PERSON

Per person

3-DAY	ITEM	90-DAY AMOUNT	HAVE	NEED	EXPIRES
●	**Prescriptions**	Ask your pharmacist or doctor about an emergency supply	☐	☐	
●	**Spare glasses or contacts and solution**	1 set	☐	☐	
●	**Written list of medicines, doses, allergies, and doctors**	1	☐	☐	
●	**Power plan for medical devices (CPAP, oxygen, hearing aids)**	Check device watts; plan battery capacity or ask your supplier	☐	☐	

MEDICAL & SAFETY · HOUSEHOLD

Per household

3-DAY	ITEM	90-DAY AMOUNT	HAVE	NEED	EXPIRES
●	**First-aid kit**	1	☐	☐	
	Bandages, gauze, tape	Assorted	☐	☐	
	Antiseptic wipes	2 boxes	☐	☐	
	Adult pain reliever	1–2 bottles	☐	☐	
	Child fever medicine	1, if children	☐	☐	
	Rehydration solution	2 packs	☐	☐	
	Thermometer	1	☐	☐	
	Cooler and ice packs for medicines that need cold	1	☐	☐	
	N95 masks	1 box	☐	☐	
	Work gloves	1 pair per adult	☐	☐	
	Insect repellent	2 bottles	☐	☐	
	Sunscreen	2 bottles	☐	☐	
●	**Fire extinguisher**	1	☐	☐	
●	**Carbon monoxide alarm with battery**	1	☐	☐	
	Smoke alarm batteries	Spares	☐	☐	

GO BAG · PER PERSON · IF YOU MUST LEAVE

☐ **Water you can carry**	On foot: as much as you can manage, plus a filter or tablets. By vehicle: 1 gal per person per day for 3 days.
☐ **No-cook food**	3 days
☐ **Medicines, glasses, and medical list**	
☐ **Copies of IDs, insurance, and important documents**	
☐ **Cash in small bills**	
☐ **Phone, charger, and power bank**	
☐ **Flashlight and spare batteries**	
☐ **Change of clothes and sturdy shoes**	
☐ **Written contact list and a family meeting spot**	

Everything else on this list stays home.

OTHER

Per household

3-DAY	ITEM	90-DAY AMOUNT	HAVE	NEED	EXPIRES
	Tarp	1	☐	☐	
	Duct tape	2 rolls	☐	☐	
	Tool kit	1	☐	☐	
●	**Cash in small bills**	Set aside	☐	☐	
●	**Copies of important documents, waterproof bag**	1 packet	☐	☐	
	Games, books, coloring supplies	Assorted	☐	☐	
	Pet food, water, and medicine	90 days, if pets	☐	☐	

STORAGE

Store food and water indoors, cool, dry, and off the floor. Garages get too hot.

Write the purchase date on everything.

Use the oldest items first and replace them as you go.

Check allergies, dietary needs, and expiration dates for your household.

Sources

CDC, water treatment: cdc.gov/water-emergency
CDC, carbon monoxide: cdc.gov/carbon-monoxide
EPA, emergency disinfection: epa.gov/ground-water-and-drinking-water/emergency-disinfection-drinking-water
FEMA, supply guidance: ready.gov/kit
Oregon State University Extension, two-bucket toilet: extension.oregonstate.edu/catalog/pub/em9334

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THE IDEA IS THE ART. THE HELP IS THE POINT.

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